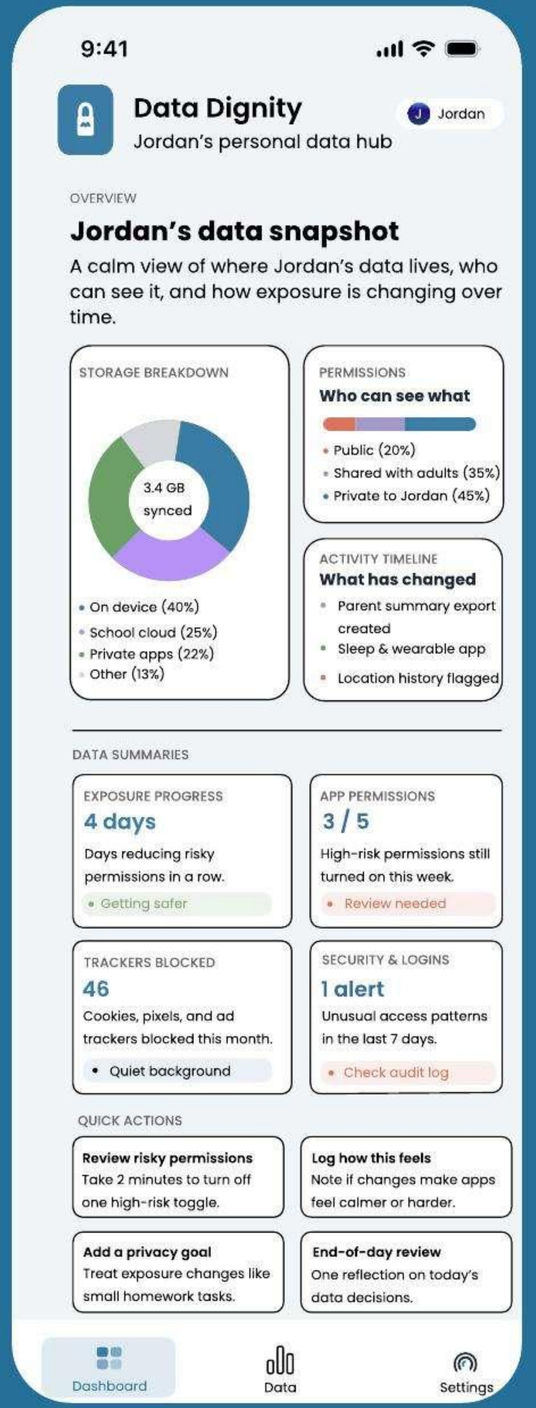
Data Dignity Application

"Returning control of personal data to the individual through calm, accessible, and human-centered design."

Bryan Hope | HER-V500 | Fall 2025



Problem Space

In the Digital Dignity era, individuals legally own their personal data, but ownership alone does not equal understanding or control. Data is scattered across platforms, hidden behind technical language, and difficult to visualize meaningfully. For younger users especially, managing privacy can feel overwhelming rather than empowering. This project explores how design can translate a complex, futuristic policy shift into a calm, usable system that supports agency without increasing cognitive load.

Design Challenge

How might we return data control to individuals without overwhelming them?

- Data systems are complex and abstract
- Interfaces often increase anxiety rather than clarity
- Accessibility must be foundational, not added later
- Especially critical for younger users managing growing digital footprints

Persona Overview

Primary Person: Jordan

- Age: 15
- Teen navigating school, apps, devices, and privacy
- Diagnosed ADHD

Jordan uses multiple school, health, and social apps daily. They want independence and control over their data but struggle with sustained focus, information overload, and unclear consequences. Jordan needs systems that feel supportive, predictable, and easy to scan.

Key Research Insights

Design Principles from market research:
Minimize Distractions (Bakken, 2022)

- Clean, minimalist layouts
- Low-saturation colors
- Consistent navigation patterns

Provide Clear Structure (Wollberg, 2025)

- One goal per section
- Step-by-step guidance
- Breadcrumb navigation

Enable User Control (Bakken, 2022)

- Customization dashboards
- Adjustable notifications
- Permission based features

Motivate Through Feedback (Bakken, 2022)

- Visual achievements
- Gentle praise and rewards
- Progress indicators

User Goals & Pain Points

Goals

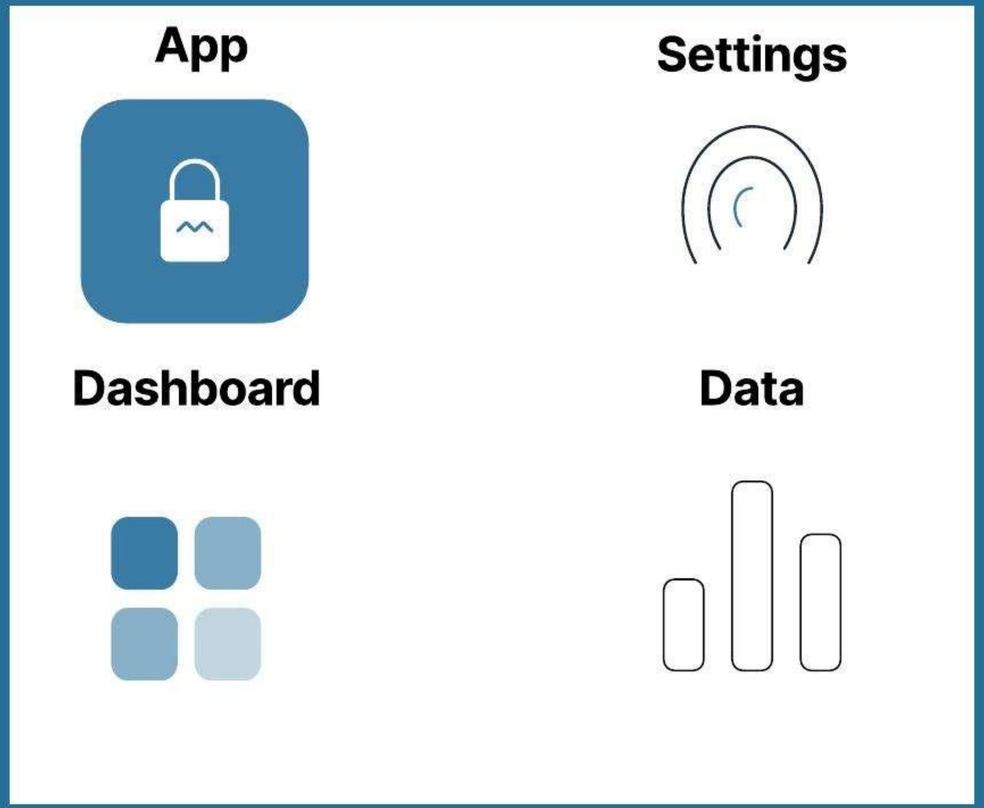
- Understand where personal data lives
- Know who can see it
- Make small, safe privacy decisions independently

Pain Points

- Dense settings menus
- Vague permission language
- Too many decisions at once
- Anxiety caused by alerts without context

Application Workflow

Custom Icons



The app is structured around three primary spaces:

1. **Dashboard** - Understand what's happening
2. **Data Management** - Organize and control sources
3. **Settings** - Customize how the system behaves

The separation reduces decision fatigue by allowing Jordan to observe first and act second.

Mood Board



The mood board focused on:

- **Calm, muted color tones**
- **Soft contrast instead of harsh alerts**
- **Friendly, non-punitive visuals**

The goal was to make privacy feel approachable rather than intimidating.

Design System Overview

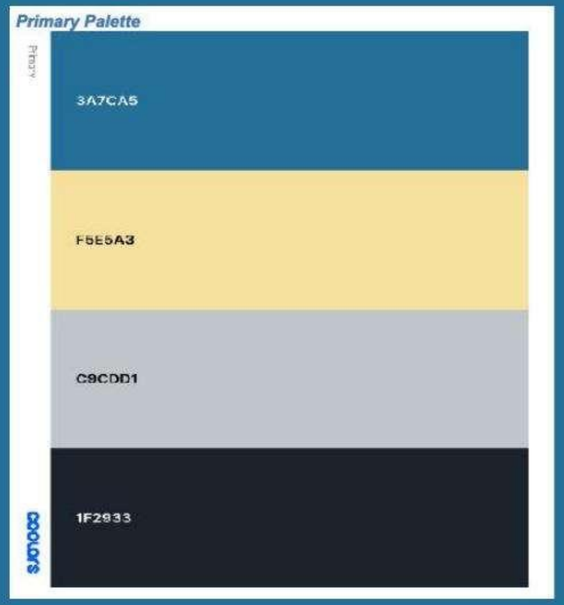
The design system serves as connective tissue across the app:

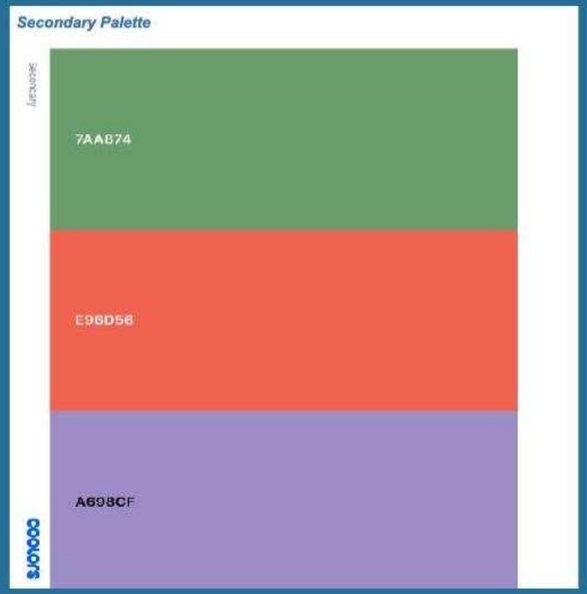
- Reusable cards
- Toggle-based interactions
- Bottom sheets for focused tasks
- Consistent spacing using an 8-pt grid

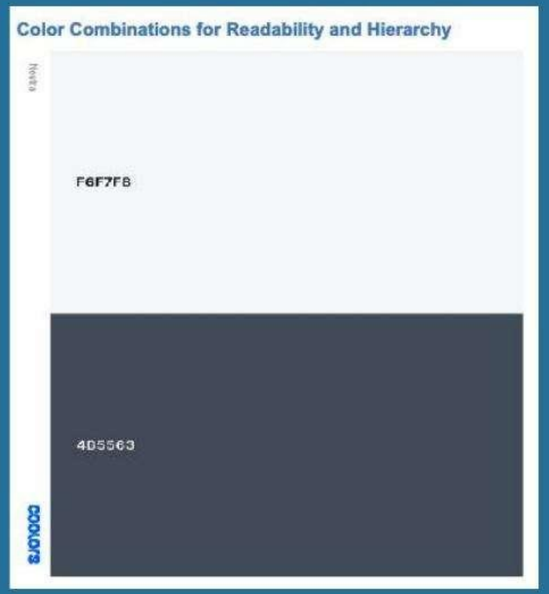
This ensures predictability and reduces cognitive strain.

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Color Palette







- **Cerulean:** Primary actions and ownership
- **Asparagus:** Success and safety
- **Burnt Sienna:** Risk and alerts
- **French Gray:** Neutral information

Colors are used sparingly and consistently to signal meaning without overstimulation.

Typography

Poppins

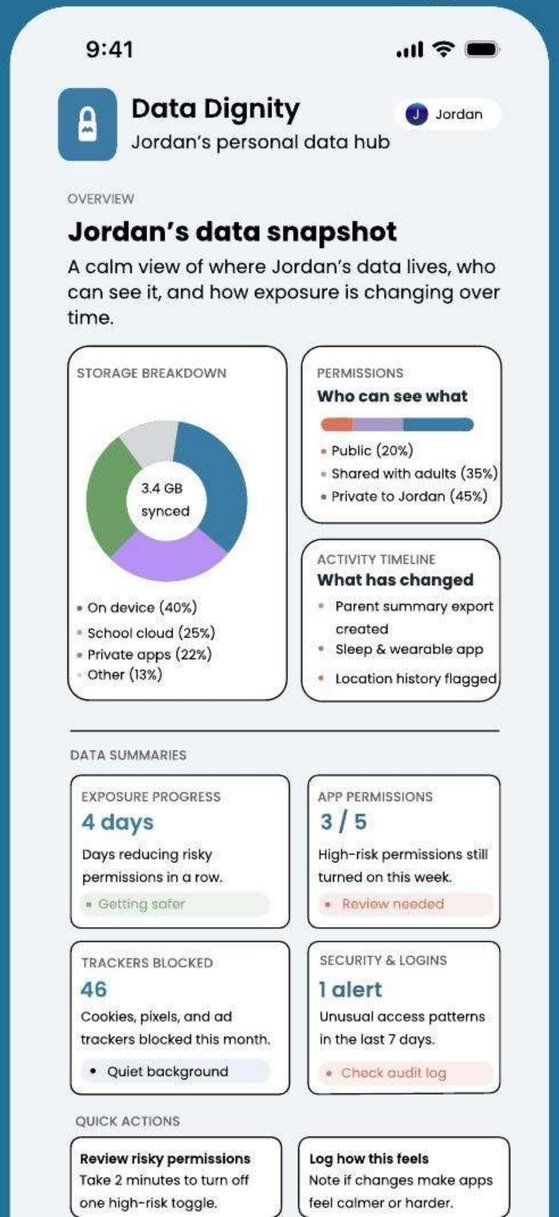
Poppins was selected for its:

- Rounded, friendly forms
- Clear hierarchy
- High legibility at small sizes

Typography scales consistently across headings, body text, and labels to support quick scanning.

Font: https://fonts.google.com/specimen/Poppins?query=poppins

Dashboard Desgin

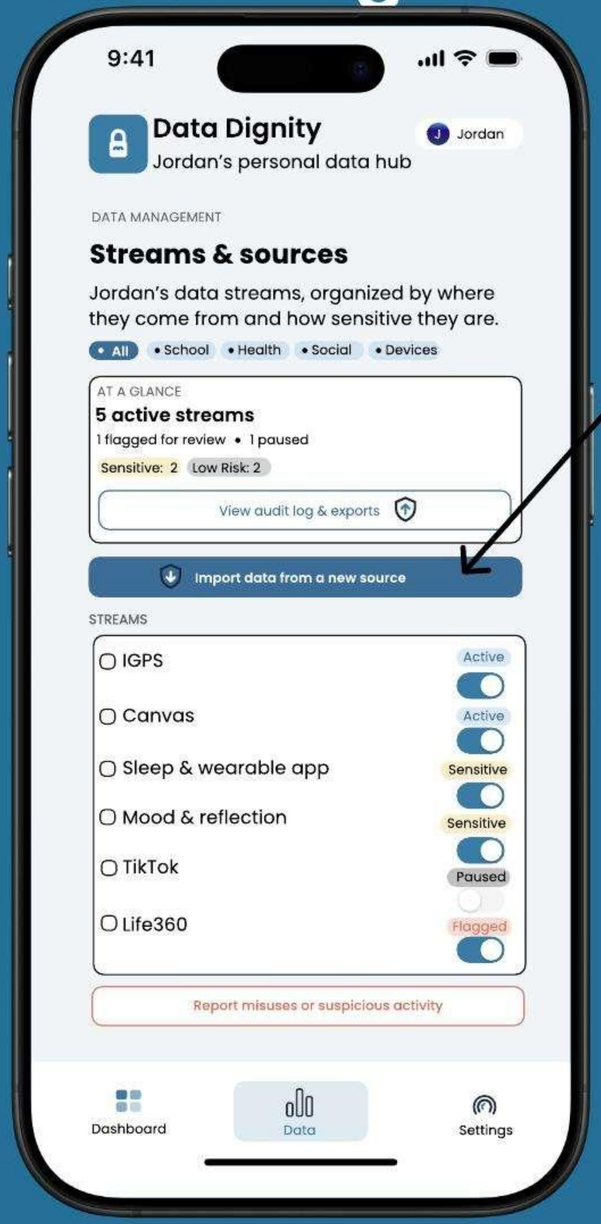


The dashboard acts as a calm overview:

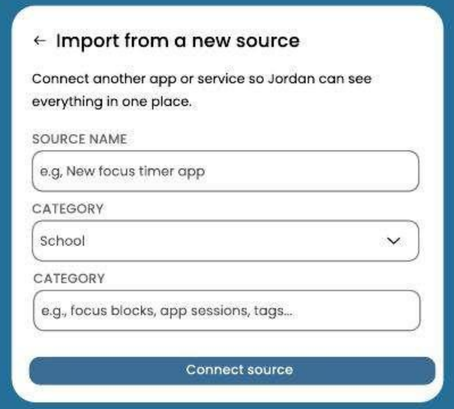
- **Two data visualizations (storage location + permissions)**
- **Category summaries**
- **Activity timeline**

This screen answers "What's happening with my data?" without asking Jordan to make decisions immediately.

Data Management





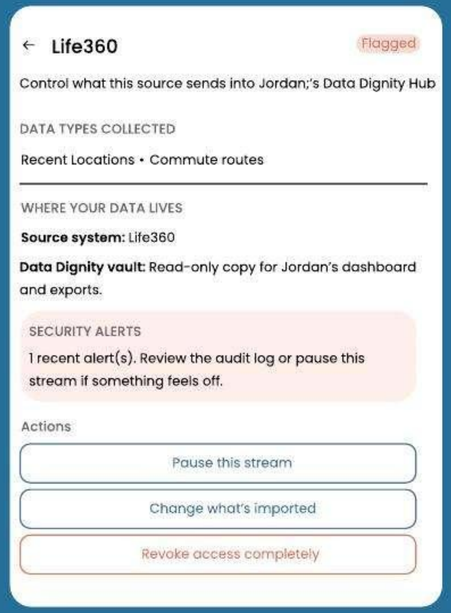


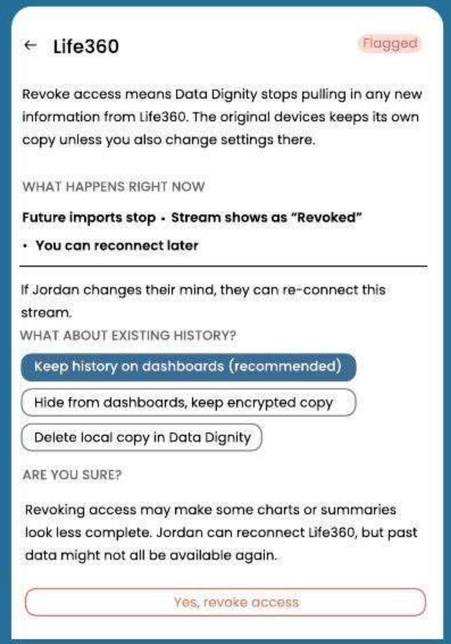
The Data Management screen shows:

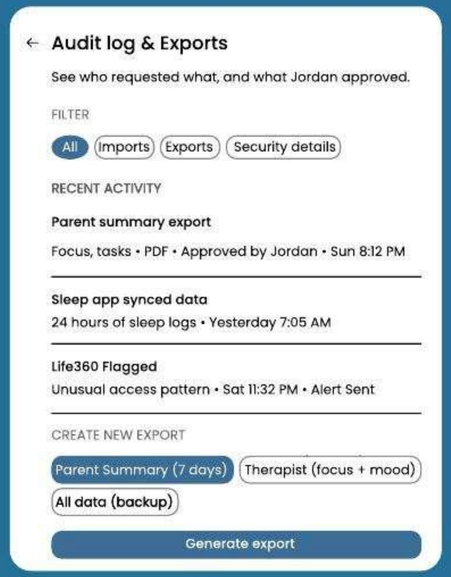
- **Individual data streams**
- **Risk flags**
- **Import options**
- **Ability to pause or revoke access**

Filtering and categorization allow Jordan to focus on one type of data at a time.

Revoke Access Flow







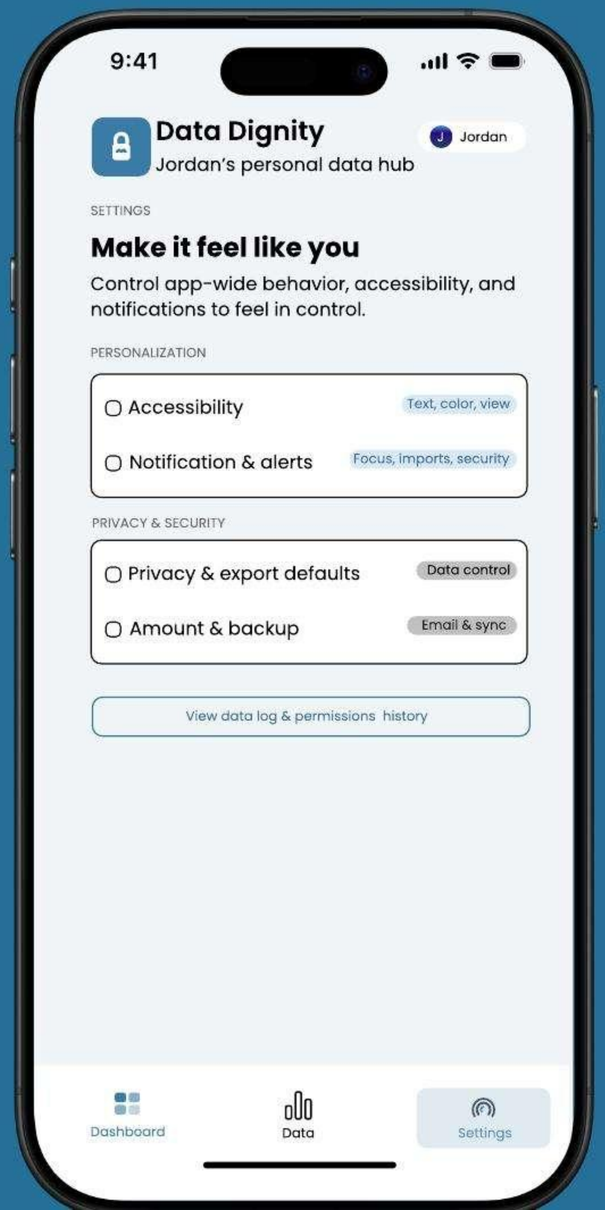


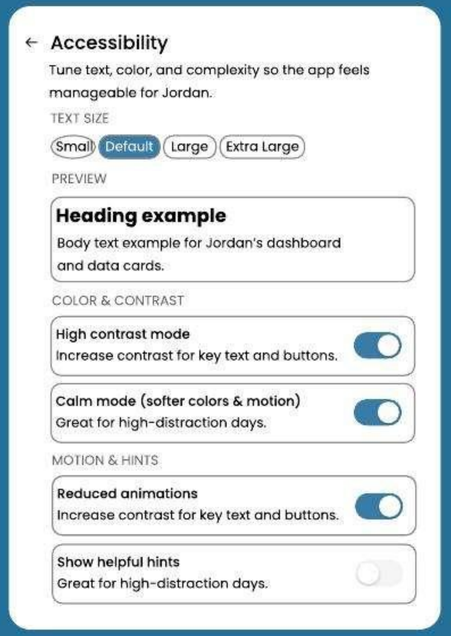
Revoking access is intentionally a separate, deliberate flow:

- **Clear explanation of consequences**
- **Confirmation step**
- **Audit log preview**

This prevents accidental actions while reinforcing trust and transparency.

Settings (Accessibility)



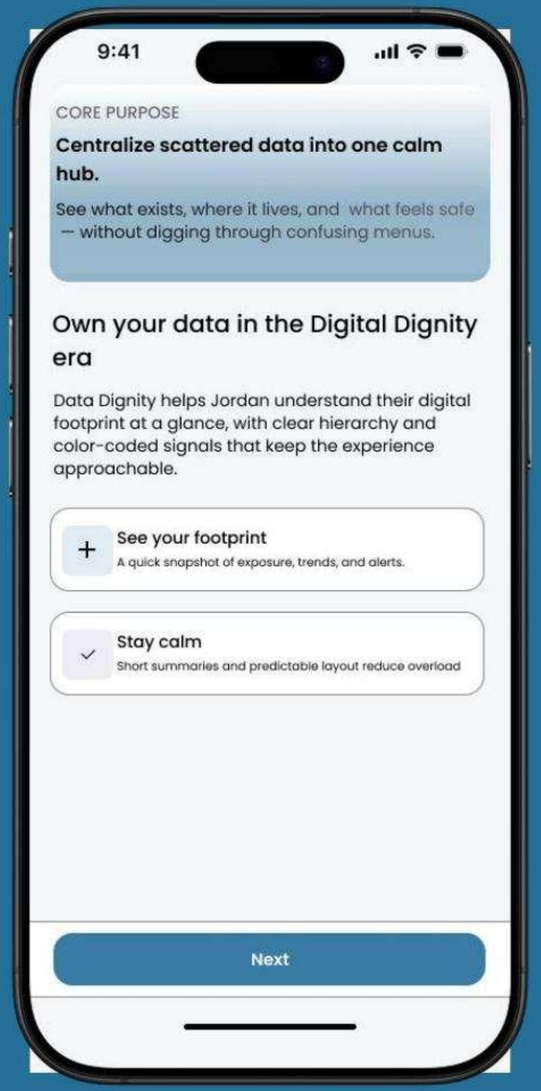


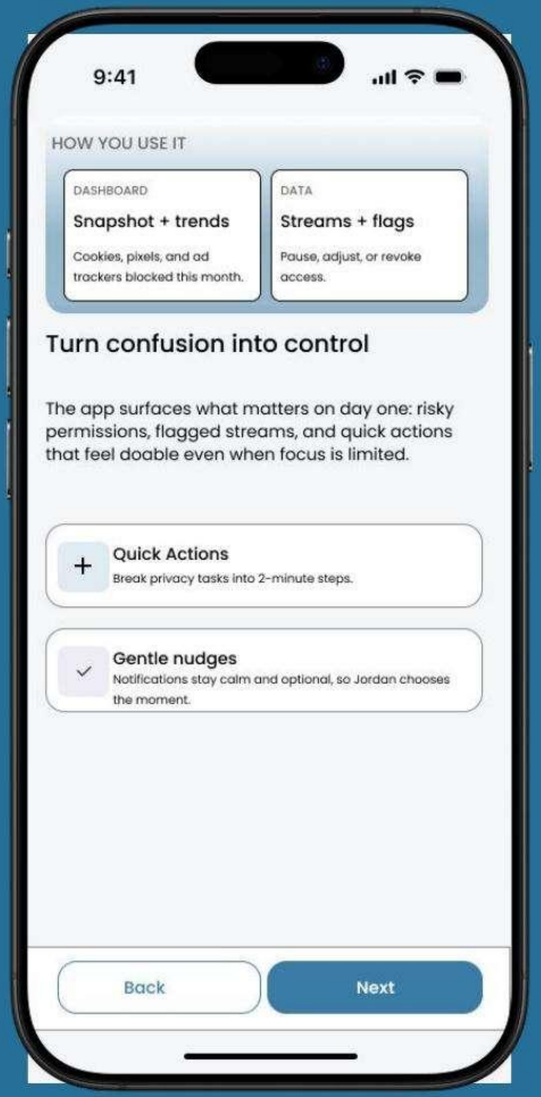
Settings support personalization and accessibility:

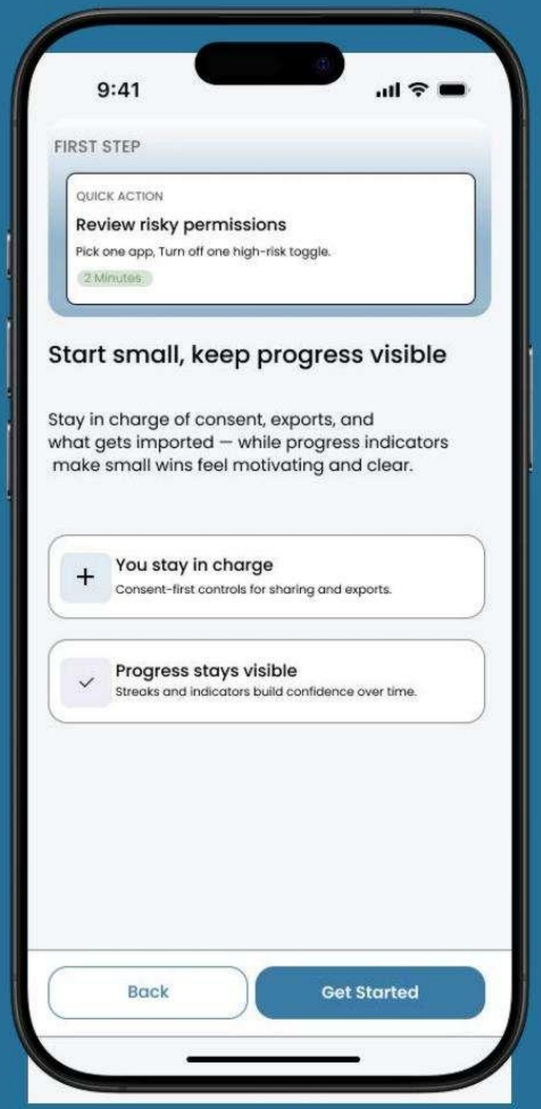
- **Text size**
- **Calm mode**
- **Reduced motion**
- **High contrast**

Jordan can adapt the system to their needs rather than adapting themselves to the system.

Onboarding





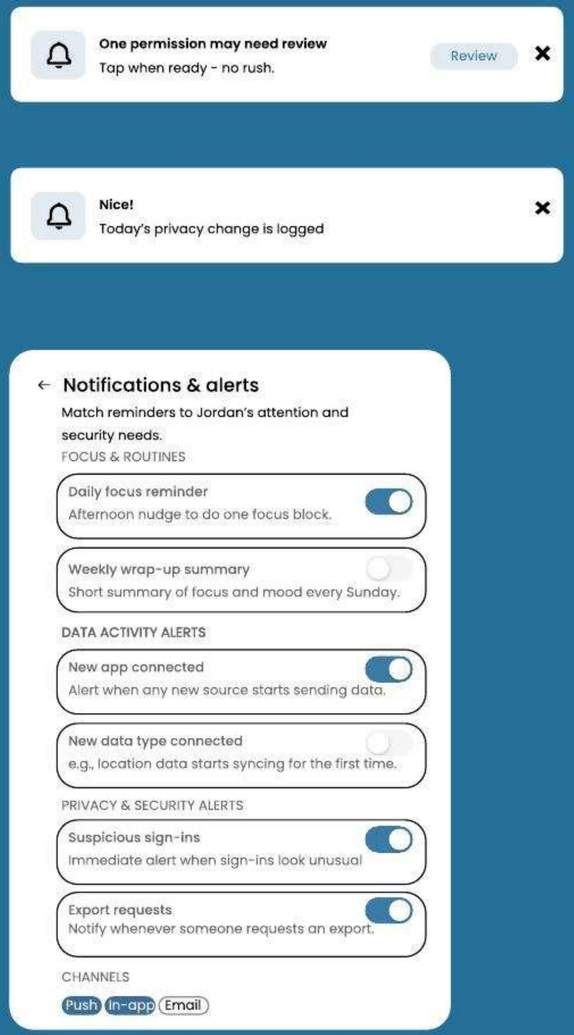


Three onboarding screens introduce:

- **What Data Dignity does**
- **How it empowers the user**
- **The first small step**

Each screen uses strong hierarchy and minimal content to pass the “3-second skim” test.

Notifications

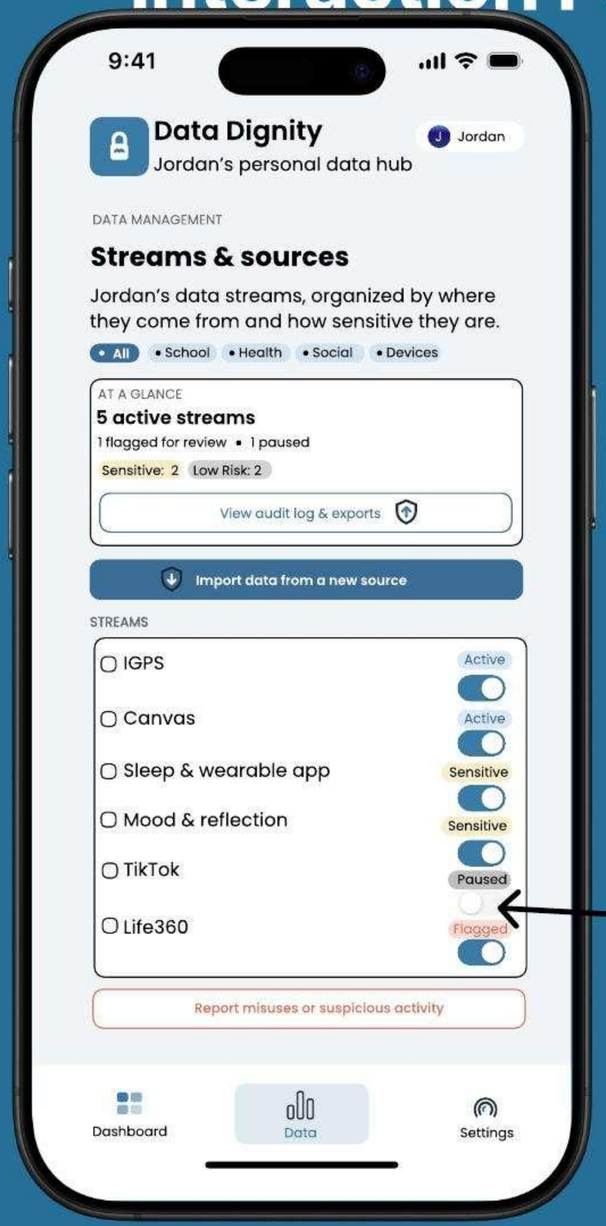


Notifications are:

- **Calm**
- **Optional**
- **Contextual**

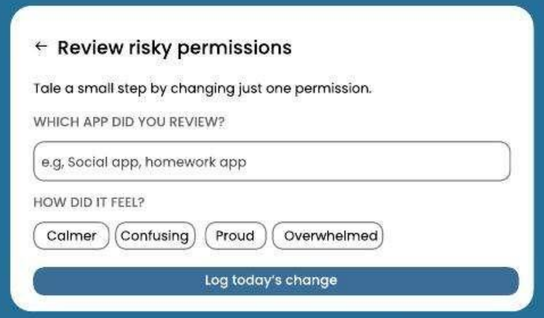
Instead of alarming language, notifications explain why something matters and what Jordan can do next.

Interaction Patterns



QUICK ACTIONS

Review risky permissions
Take 2 minutes to turn off one high-risk toggle.



Toggle switch for stream permissions

Users are encouraged to view their data streams and make adjustments.

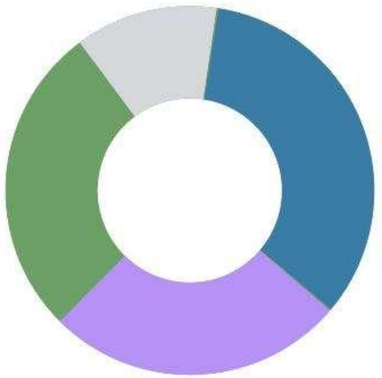
Consistent patterns include:

- Card layouts
- Toggle switches
- Chips for selection
- Bottom sheets for focus

These repeated interactions reduce learning effort across the app.

Design Rationale

STORAGE BREAKDOWN



- On device (40%)
- School cloud (25%)
- Private apps (22%)
- Other (13%)

PERMISSIONS

Who can see what



- Public (20%)
- Shared with adults (35%)
- Private to Jordan (45%)

SECURITY & LOGINS

1 alert

Unusual access patterns in the last 7 days.

- Check audit log

This design supports digital dignity by:

- **Reducing cognitive overload**
- **Making data visible and understandable**
- **Supporting autonomy without pressure**

Accessibility and agency are treated as core features, not add-ons.

Prototype

A fully interactive Figma prototype demonstrates:

- **Dashboard**
- **Data Management**
- **Settings**
- **Onboarding**

All interactions follow the established design system in these slides

Link: https://www.figma.com/proto/n9lq4F0HwpF75RuCL5217U/Data-Dignity---Template-Bryan-Hope?node-id=10916-11611&t=NBtybaOF1DTVA0CW-0&scaling=scale-down&content-scaling=fixed&page-id=10659%3A1984&starting-point-node-id=10916%3A11611&show-proto-sidebar=1

Impact & Future Vision

This system can scale beyond teens to families, caregivers, and adults. By prioritizing clarity, consent, and emotional safety, Data Dignity demonstrates how ethical data tools can succeed in an emerging market.

Works Cited

Bakken, H. (2022). Designing an online intervention for adults with ADHD [Master's thesis, University of Bergen]. Bergen Open Research Archive. https://bora.uib.no/bora-xmlui/handle/11250/3001949

Wollberg, S. (2025, January 17). Inclusive user research for ADHD in HCI: A literature review. Sara Wollberg. https://sarawollberg.com/

Thanks for a great semester :)